AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A112T
Cultures
Main – All Branches
Midterm Exam

2024-2025/Spring Semester
Date:8 April 2025
2:30 - 4:30

Number of Exam Pages: 3 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 Hours**

INSTRUCTIONS

This Exam consists of TWO PARTS.

Part 1 contains 3 Short Answer Questions. You must choose TWO and fully answer them in PARAGRAPH FORMAT.

Part 2 contains 2 Essay Questions. You must choose ONE of them and fully answer it in ESSAY FORMAT.

Write the question number next to each answer.

Do not answer more questions than required.

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Part 1: Short Answer Questions
(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Choose TWO of the following questions and answer them in paragraph form. Each answer should be approximately 80-90 words, fully addressing all aspects of the question with supporting evidence from the course materials. Each paragraph must include a clear topic sentence, sufficient supporting details, and a concluding statement.

1. What is the **Athenian Acropolis**, and why is it important in Greek history?
2. What were the primary **obligations** and **responsibilities** expected of **Athenian citizens**?
3. According to **Pliny**, what are the key characteristics of the **Domus Aurea**? Do you think that Pliny's description of the palace is accurate and objective?

Part 2: Essay Questions
(20 points)

Choose ONE of the essay prompts below and write a comprehensive response in essay format. Your essay should be around 350 words, covering all relevant aspects of the question and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essay with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. Fully elaborate on the **Athenian citizens' idealized view of what life at home (the *oikos*)** should be like with reference to the primary sources, i.e., **the picture on the Greek clay jar** and **the two speeches by Lysias and Demosthenes**.
   Questions to consider:
   a. What does the word oikos mean? Who was part of the oikos?
   b. What duties were expected of men in both the private and public spheres of Athenian society, and how did these roles contribute to their status and reputation?
   c. What roles and obligations did women have within the family structure of ancient Athens, and how did their rights compare to those of fathers and husbands?
   d. How were children expected to contribute to the family unit in ancient Athens, and what roles and duties did they have within the household?
   e. What does the image on the Greek clay jar show about the ideal life of Athenian citizens at home (the oikos)?
   f. How do the speeches by Lysias and Demosthenes describe the roles and responsibilities of family members in the oikos?

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5. Analyze **Suetonius's portrayal of Nero**, exploring how he constructs a negative image of the emperor by linking Nero's personality, the extravagant Domus Aurea, the Great Fire of Rome, and Nero's response to the disaster. Consider how Suetonius uses descriptions of Nero's character, the palace's features, Nero's alleged role in the fire, and his subsequent actions to shape Nero's historical reputation.

Questions to consider:

a. How does Suetonius describe Nero's personality?
b. How does the Domus Aurea reflect Nero's character?
c. How does Suetonius link Nero to the Great Fire?
d. How does Suetonius portray Nero's reaction to the fire?
e. How does Suetonius shape Nero's historical reputation?

End of the Exam!

EGYPT

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